Dean Satine

Gameplay Systems & Character Designer

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PROFILE

I am a gameplay-focused designer with extensive experience creating and iterating on small- to medium-scope games across multiple genres. I specialize in systems and character design, with a strong interest in what makes mechanics exciting, readable, and balanced for players. I have significant hands-on experience working in Unreal Engine 5 using Blueprint to prototype and implement features. My design approach emphasizes creating the most engaging experience possible within tight constraints, allowing for efficient iteration and cost-effective development. I thrive in collaborative environments due to my social nature, and enjoy receiving and applying feedback, and am motivated by solving player-facing problems through thoughtful design and technical implementation. I would love to contribute to multiplayer-focused projects and continue growing as a gameplay designer within a production team.

EDUCATION

Game Development & Interactive Media September 2023 – Present

Ontario Tech University

DESIGN SKILLS

- Systems & character design
- Working with small game scopes
- Identifying player pain points & improving player experience
- Prototyping & iterating on mechanics quickly
- Communicating design intent through documentation and playtests.
- Ability to analyze problems, generate solutions, & communicate design decisions

TECHNICAL/PROFESSIONAL SKILLS

- Proficiency with Unreal Engine 5 Blueprints/C++ & Unity C#
- Version control using Git & GitHub
- Cross-discipline collaboration with artists, engineers and designers
- Time management & Critical thinking under deadlines
- Gameplay debugging and issue resolution across Unreal Engine and Unity projects
- Strong communication abilities and adaptability
- Growth mindset & efficient learner

EXPERIENCE

Systems & Character Designer May 2025 – August 2025

Full Circle CS

- Rapidly prototyped a pachinko-style scoring system and character troop mechanic within one day to accelerate team progress
- Implemented gameplay logic using Blueprint-based systems focused on readability and player feedback
- Collaborated with designers and developers to integrate features into the core game loop
- Developed skills working in a professional environment for clients with tight deadline expectations.
- Prototyped low-scope augment-style systems to introduce strategic variety while maintaining system simplicity
- Iterated on gameplay mechanics through internal playtesting and feedback

VP of Communications/Student Relations February 2024 - Present

Game Development Student Association

- Developed skills on working with a team, meeting tight deadlines, time management, organizing events, and professionalism.
- Working cooperatively in teams to organize events & sessions for hundreds of students.
- Arranged and facilitated meetings with Ubisoft developers to secure sponsorships and strengthen industry partnerships for the university
- Awarded the Most Valuable Player award for the 2024-2025 school year.

Game Development & Interactive Media Program September 2023 - Present

Ontario Tech University

Deity Excidium (1st Year)

- Designed and balanced boss attack patterns and abilities to create readable, engaging combat encounters
- Implemented combat behaviors and iterated based on player feedback
- Led a 6-person team by coordinating design direction and cross-discipline collaboration

Mugshot (2nd Year)

- Designed office-themed weapons and combat mechanics aligned with the project's thematic vision
- Implemented player combat features and tuned weapon feel and pacing
- Provided creative direction and managed milestones for a 6-person development team

Trisoul Tower (3rd Year)

- Designed and implemented the player combat system and environmental interaction mechanics
- Created enemy archetypes including basic enemies, mini-bosses, and a final boss with distinct behavioral logic
- Refactored project scope and design direction to improve feasibility and ensure on-time completion
- Designed progression-based weapons with unique ability mechanics to increase gameplay variety

Cybernetic Strategy (4th year)

- Designed and implemented a prototype auto-battler featuring modular unit, trait, and progression systems
- Built data-driven unit and trait mechanics to support rapid balance iteration and tuning
- Prototyped low-scope augment-style systems to introduce strategic variety while maintaining system simplicity

REFERENCES

Professor Gavin Ball – Assistant Teaching Professor
Game Development and Interactive Media, Full Circle CS
Ontario Tech University
gavin.ball@fullcirclecs.com

Rom Di Prisco – Composer / Producer
www.romdiprisco.com
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